

Hazrat Adam عليه السلام

Allah created Adam عليه السلام from dust and before this matter had been gathered together He had informed the Angels that very soon he should be creating a being from dust who will be called 'man' and who will be granted the vice-gerency of this world.

The matter from which Adam عليه السلام was formed became mixed with such earth which always adopted new forms and when the form of Adam عليه السلام was ready, Allah breathed into it the soul and immediately the form became a body made up of bones, muscle and skin, alive and endowed with emotions, feelings, intelligence and passions.

At that time a command from Allah came to the Angels that they should prostrate before Adam عليه السلام. All of them fell prostrate in answer to this command, except *Iblees* who through his pride and arrogance refused to obey the command.

The Arguments of Iblees

We know that Allah is the knower of the seen and the unseen, and He knows the inner secrets of the hearts as well as the past, present and future. By way of putting *Shaitan* to the test, He asked him: "What caused you to refuse to prostrate when I commanded you to do so?"

" He replied:

"I am better than him. You have created me from fire and him you have created from dust." (7:12)

What he meant was that he was created from fire which seeks the lofty regions and superiority, while Adam ﷺ was a mere earthly being. Why should a lofty being of fire prostrate before an earthly creature? After all in all aspects he was superiors. It there should be any prostration, Adam ﷺ should prostrate before him.

The unfortunate *Shaitan*, in his involvement with his own pride and arrogance failed to understand that as both he and Adam ﷺ were creatures created by Allah, Allah was the one better to understand who was superior. He failed to understand that superiority was not confined to the essence from which one was created, but was largely dependent upon the qualities which Allah has put inside any being.

Because *Shaitan's* answer was based upon his pride and arrogance, Allah made it clear to him that this arrogance has made him blind so as to deny Allah's rights as creator, thereby considering Him to be unjust. Allah made it clear to him that his ignorance had made him unable to understand realities and as a result he was the cause of his own over lasting destruction and that would be its result.

Iblees Begs for a Time

When *Iblees* realized that his disobedience, and his arrogance and his accusation of injustice against Allah has forever banished him from the mercy of Allah and deprived him of entrance into Paradise, instead of repenting to Allah and exhibiting over his actions, he asked that he be granted a time of respite till the time of *Qiyamat*.

At that time Allah's wisdom was in favour with that and his request was approved. On hearing this he once again exhibited his *Shaitani* tendencies.

He said:

"You have expelled me from Paradise. Adam ﷺ is the cause of my suffering this humiliation. I shall lead his children astray. I shall come upon them from all sides and cause most of them to be ungrateful to you, except your sincere servants who will be safe from my plans."

Allah replies:

"I do not care. There is with us a natural law of retribution for all deeds. As will be done, so will be their reward. And whoever of the children of Adam ﷺ that will turn away from me and follow you, will enter hell like you as punishment. Get you out of here in humiliation and disgrace and with your ill fortune and together with your followers go and await the everlasting curse."

Adam ﷺ, as *Khalifa*

We have already mentioned that when Allah intended to create Adam ﷺ, he told the Angels:

"I shall place in the earth a *Khalifa*. He will have the ability to carry out his own intentions and wishes and will be able to perform all deeds and he will be able to do whatever he wishes according to his intentions. He will be as if he is exhibition of my will."

When the Angels heard this announcement they were greatly surprised they said: "If it is the aim in creating this being that he should glorify your name by night and by day and to continuously praise you, then for that purpose we would be better, we who at all times are busy with singing your praises and all the time obey your commands. We expect that this being created of dust will be inclined toward evil. It may be that he will proceed to commit evil and shed blood on earth. O lord, what is the object of this creation?"

First of all Allah taught the Angels the lesson that it was not proper for the creation to be hasty in passing judgement over the affairs of the creator. It is not proper for them to cast doubts into His actions, especially where they also mention their own superiority. After all the Creator knows all those things, which are unknown to them.

The Teaching of Adam ﷺ

Through this questioning of the Angels their aim was not to engage the creator in a debate or to raise objections against Him. What they actually wanted to know was what was the object of Adam (*Alaihis Salām*)'s creation. They desired that the object of his creation should also be disclosed to them. For this reason, Allah after pointing out to them their shortcoming in the manner in which they put their question, wanted to explain to them in a practical manner, by word and deed so that they out of their own would have to admit Adam (*Alaihis Salām*)'s superiority and the greatness of Allah's wisdom and so that their own inability become self-evident. Hence Allah endowed Adam ﷺ with His greatest attribute in knowledge and taught him the knowledge of things. Then He brought him before the Angels and asked them: "What knowledge have you regarding these things?"

They had no knowledge. They resided within the Divine Nearness and realized immediately that the aim of question was not to put them to attest as they were never taught those things before. They realized that the aim was to admonish them and point out to them that the post of being Allah's *Khalifa* on earth was not dependent upon any amount of glorification and praising but is dependent upon the knowledge one has. This is so because rule on earth is impossible without knowledge.

The Angels were brought to the realisation that in view of the fact that Allah had made Adam ﷺ the manifestation of His attribute of knowledge, he was more suitable to be the *Khalifa* on earth, not they. Moreover the Angels in spite of their services being rendered to Allah, are completely free of all worldly passions and needs and they were also unacquainted with those passions and needs. And because Adam ﷺ had to deal with these things at all times, his knowledge of these things was something natural to him—Those qualities which had been placed in him by the Creator. He had been taught everything that had been necessary for him to know.

They were made to realize that they were not in acted of food and drink and as such were not obliged to study the treasures and sources of sustenance that was placed in the earth. They had no fear of drowning in the seas for them to invent the use of ships and boats. Neither were they in need of inventing various means of treatment for ailments and sicknesses; or joining of various chemical substances or to study the special qualities of nature's products or to study and investigate the secrets of the Universe medical discoveries etc. etc. There was for them no need to become acquainted with so many types of knowledge. Undoubtedly these matters were only suitable for Adam ﷺ to endow himself with; so that he alone could have been Allah's vicegerent on earth.

Hawwa's Appearance

Hazrat lived in Paradise for quite a time on his own but all along felt a sort of loneliness and need for a partner in life as a natural need. Then Allah created Hawwa and when Adam ﷺ met her as his life's partner he became very happy and contented.

The two of them had permission to reside in Paradise and to enjoy of all the fruits of Paradise except the fruits of one specific tree, and to avoid going near to it.

Exit from Paradise

Iblees found a way towards misleading Adam ﷺ. He, through his whisperings, cast the thought into their minds that tree was the tree of life everlasting and that to eat of its fruits would bring everlasting life in Paradise in peace and comfort in the presence of Allah. He swore an oath that he was a well-wishing adviser to them and not an enemy. Hearing this Adam ﷺ exhibited man's natural inclination toward forget fullness and he ackoned that Allah's command was a mere prohibiting one and not a Divine order from on High. In this he made a Major mistake and ate from the Prohibited tree. As soon as he did that he became aware of his human needs and necessities. He realised that he was naked, without clothes and both he and Hawwa used the leaves of fig to cover their private parts. It was as if this was the beginning of man's civilization.

As soon as this event took place the admonishment came from Allah's side, that how is it that in spite of the Divine Order he had still transgressed? In his reply Adam ﷺ, unlike *Shaitan* who tried to engage the Lord in on debate and tried to justify his actions with various explanatory interpretations; admitted his fault in penitent terms and with

sorrow. What happened was not out of rebellion or clear disobedience, but rather out of the human weakness of forgetfulness. Hence he begged for forgiveness and took refuge in repentance.

Allah accepted his excuse and forgave him but by then the time had arrived for Adam ﷺ had to take over the duty of being Allah's *Khalifa* on earth. Therefore together with this announcement of pardon, the order was also given that Adam ﷺ and Hawwa and their children will have to live on the earth for a specific time and so also will their enemy Shaitan with all his enmity. This meant that Adam ﷺ will have to live on earth between the two opposite Angelic and Shaitanic powers. It was further stipulated that should Adam ﷺ and his children prove themselves to be true representatives, then the original homeland of the Paradise will become theirs unto eternity.

"Proceed you and Hawwa to live on earth and perform your duty as two servants of Allah."

In this manner Adam ﷺ and his life's partner Hawwa landed on earth.

Adam ﷺ in the Qur'ān

In the Qur'ān the name of Hazrat Adam ﷺ appears twenty-five times in twenty-five verses and among the mention of the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*), he as the father of all mankind is the first to be mentioned. He is mentioned in the following *Surahs*: *Baqarah*, *Aa'raaf*, *Israel*, *Kahf* and *Taaha* where he is mentioned by name as well as by attributes. In *Surah Hijr* and *Saud* he is mentioned only by his attributes, whereas in *Surah Al-e-Imrān*, *Ma'idah*, *Maryam* and *Yaseen* his name is mentioned by the way.

Lessons from the Story

In the story of Hazrat Adam عليه السلام there are numerous lessons to be learnt and also many advices to be given. It is difficult to mention all those lessons here. However, it will seem appropriate to draw attention to some of those lessons.

1. The secret of Allah's mysteries are many and not every man, no matter how near he may reside to Allah's presence, can comprehend them all. For this reason, the Angels of Allah, although being very near to Him, were unable to understand the wisdom of his creation. Until such time that the whole truth was exposed to them, they were perplexed and confused.
2. When Allah casts His attention towards any thing, no matter how insignificant or despicable, that thing is immediately lifted and raised to a high position and becomes honoured and respected. For example, here a handful of dust was taken and with Allah attention showered upon it, it becomes transformed into the '*Khalifa* of Allah.' Similarly, with Allah's look of favour and beneficence, cast upon his position of Prophethood and messenger-ship, he was raised to great heights of spiritual blessings.
3. In spite of man being endowed with great honour and high rank, he still remained by virtue of his natural human weaknesses and these human frailties remained with him and it was this human weakness which in spite of his high position, caused him to be overcome with forgetfulness which caused him to become influenced by the whisperings of *Shaitan*.
4. Although being a faulty one, if man's heart gets filled with sorrow and repentance, the doors of mercy does

not become closed to him, and he does not, become one filled without hope of mercy. However a major condition for this mercy is that there should be sincerity and truth. And just as Adam ﷺ become a recipient of that mercy so also all his offspring will find that pardon and mercy available to them.

In the presence of Allah any insolence, disobedience and rebellion against His order can destroy one's greatest deeds of righteousness and virtue and can become the cause of everlasting loss and disgrace. The story of *Iblees* is indeed a story with a great lesson of warning. Note how had been previously noted for having been one with thousands of years of righteous deeds and now through arrogance and insolence displayed towards Allah all that has come to nought. The poet says:

"*Shaitan* was destroyed through refusal to perform one prostration And even if for thousand of years he should perform it nothing will happen to offset that."

"O you who have eyes and understanding take a lesson from the story of *Shaitan* who was destroyed by his arrogance and prick."

Masa'il Concerning the Story

Maulana Mohammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy has extracted twelve *Masa'il* from the story of Hazrat Adam ﷺ. Most of these *Masa'il* are of an Academic nature-not dealing with lessons derived from the story. Of these *Masa'il*, three are being mentioned now, which deal with points of knowledge in the interest of the readers.

1. How was Hawwa created?

The Qur'ān says:

"And from that *Nafs* created his mate...." (5:4)

This verse does not give the details of how Hawwa was created. For this reason it contains the possibility of both forms of creation, viz that it is possibly an indication of Hawwa being created from the rib-bone of Adam عليه السلام as is the well-known story as is also contained in the Bible. It also contains the other possibility that Allah created her from the same original dust from which man was created, as a life-partner for him. As far as the first theory is concerned there are reports in Sahih Bukhary and Sahih Muslim that Hawwa was created from the rib of Adam عليه السلام.

The well-known research scholar explains that her being created from a rib is given by way of a metaphor in this sense that she has a nature and temperament like a rib bone, which is half-round and if a person is going to try and straighten its crookedness, it will break. Thus just as one should make use of the rib bone as it is in spite of its crookedness, without trying to straighten its crookedness. Similarly one should treat a woman with sympathetic kindness, otherwise if harshness is going to be used, Then instead of pleasurable results, the end result will be unpleasant. In short, the interpretation of the above verse according to the research scholars of Islām inclines towards this meaning. This means that the Qur'ān does not only refer to the creation of Hawwa but wishes to indicate that she is also a creation of Allah just like man is.

2. The Second question is this: When it is remembered that Hazrat Adam عليه السلام is a Prophet of Allah. We believe that the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) are all sinless beings so how is this 'Ismat of the Prophet's reconciled with the fact that Adam عليه السلام was guilty of disobedience and sin?

Before answering this question a short discussion should be given on the point of the '*Ismat* of the Prophets.'

Allah, the creator of this universe, created man with divers qualities. For example He placed in man good as well as bad qualities, so that man is able to perform good as well as bad deeds. He is also able to make intentions towards good as well as towards bad. This ability to intend good as well as bad is the distinguishing factor of man's make-up. From time to time Allah chooses from among men bearing these opposite qualities some human being to be His Messenger or Prophet for the sake of guiding mankind to the path of righteousness and true guidance and to walk the path towards Allah. The last in the line of these Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) is the blessed person Muhammad ﷺ. And when his person is chosen for this duty, it is necessary that his life shall be free from all forms of sin and also be devoid of all forms of disobedience. At the same time it is also necessary that he should be a human being, who eats, drinks, sleeps and interacts with his family members and relatives, while being free of all sins, in practice and in intention. That is because he is to act as Allah's representative, guiding men towards all righteousness. In spite of a human being created with those opposite qualities in him, all forms of evil emanating from him, has been declared to be impossible, both in intention and in practical terms, so that his every intention, every action, every word and each and every movement from his side can become an example for all Universe. However, because of a human being the ability to forget and to commit a mistake has remained in him, and sometimes come out into the open. As soon as this happens he is made aware there of and withdraw from it. As for forgetfulness, the matter is clear in that he is not responsible for any evil. As far as a fault or mistake is concerned, these pertain to those acts committed without there being any

intention of evil to be committed, neither is there any intention of rebellion against commands, nor is there the aim to go against the commands of Allah, while at the same time the act is not in itself evil and iniquitous. Bearing all this in mind, although this deed, (the fault or mistake) in itself is a permissible deed, but is not a suitable deed to be performed by the doer due to his special position. Due to special rank this person has with Allah, as soon as such a deed emanates from him and due to Allah's protection over him, he is soon warned thereof and admonished, that such a deed does not become him and is very unsuitable and inappropriate.

All these things mentioned above is known as the *Ismat* (innocence, sinless nature) of the Prophets.'

Adam (Alaihis Salām)'s Ismat

After the above explanation, if we ponder over the story of Nabi Adam ﷺ, we come to know that in *Surah Baqarah* it has been said clearly that the fault committed by Nabi Adam ﷺ was not a sin or disobedience on his part, but was in fact a minor mistake: In verse (2:36) the Qur'ān states:

"And *Shaitan* made them slip." (2:36)

In *Surah A'raaf* it states:

"Then *Shaitan* began to whisper to them."

And in *Surah Taaha* it states the reason for this fault and this whispering and at the same time cleared Nabi Adam ﷺ of any intention of sin or any sinful practice.

"And we had already beforehand taken the corenaul from Adam ﷺ, But he forgot and we found on his part no firm resolve (to commit disobedience)." (20:116)

By stating this Allah has clearly established the doctrine of Nabi Adam ﷺ being sinless and innocent.

In the story of Nabi Adam ﷺ mention is also made of the Angels and also of the 'Jinn'. Both these being are special creations of Allah or they may refer to two powers, i.e., the angelic power and the *Shaitanic* power.

The Angels

What ever the Qur'ān and the *Hadith* have taught us of the Angels, the end result thereof is this that we have not been told the true facts about their creation and neither do we see them. But it has been made compulsory upon us to accept their presence and to believe that they are a special creation of Allah.

The Jinn

Similarly the 'Jinn' also is a special creation of Allah. Here too we are not fully informed of their creation and they too are not visible to us like the rest of humanity. But the Qur'ān has made it compulsory upon us to believe that they are special creation of Allah, also subject to the laws of *Shariat*. They also have a system of births and deaths among them and among them there are righteous ones as well as evil ones.

Iblees (Shaitan)

From verses of the Qur'ān we come to know that *Shaitan* belongs to the offspring of the 'Jinn' and according to the Qur'ān, *Shaitan* himself admitted in front of Allah that he was created of fire.

From the Arranger of this Volume

The story of Nabi Adam ﷺ, apart from the fact that it gives some sound advised and serves as a means of admonishing mankind; is "also important" in this sense that it throws lights upon the object of man's creation, gives man's position on earth, and also in view of this position explains his strivings, the conclusion of which is the following:

1. Allah made Adam ﷺ his vice-gerent and sent him into this world. Here, he is to strive to attain the object for which man was created.
2. The criterion for being the *Khalifa* of Allah is not constant recitation of *Tasbeeh*, *Tahleel*, *Taqdees* or *Tamjeed*, but is only the being endowed with knowledge.
3. Allah granted Adam ﷺ 'the knowledge of things' and thereby endowed him with His greatest attribute of which he is a perfect manifestation.
4. Man's superiority over the angels is because of this quality of knowledge and not because of profuse recitations of *Tasbeeh* or *Takbeer*.

Allamah Iqbal has in poetic lines drawn the picture of Nabi Adam (*Alaihis Salām*)'s exit from Paradise and his descent upon the earth. We now quote those lines of poetry:

"You have been granted the impatience of night and day.
I know not whether you are earthly or heavenly.
I have heard that out of dust you were created
Your nature is both of the stars and the moon.
If your beauty you should see in a dream
Your gratefulness will be as thousand happiness.

Earth welcomes Adam ﷺ

"Open your eyes and look! See the earth, see the skies, and see the space above.

See the sun rising from the eastern firmament be not restless."

Qaabil and Haabil

The Qur'ān does not mention the names of Nabi Adam (Alaihis Salām)'s two sons. It only referred to "the two sons of Adam ﷺ." However these are the names mentioned in the *Towraat*. According to some reports a great dispute arose between these brothers over their marriage. In order to settle the dispute Nabi Adam ﷺ suggested that both of them perform a sacrifice and place it before Allah for acceptance. The one whose sacrifice will be accepted, will be given the right to execute his intention.

According to the *Towraat*, it was a practice at that time that the sacrifice should be placed upon a lofty place. A fire-bolt would then strike from heaven and burn it up. Haabil, brought a fat sheep from among his flock of sheep while Qaabil brought a quantity of inferior quality grain. From this their intention and sincerity could be gauged.

The fire-bolt from on high burn up Haabil's offering as a sign of the acceptance of his offer. Seeing this, Qaabil could not bear the humiliation and threatened to kill his brother. Haabil replied: 'I will not lift up my hands against you. Do as you wish. As for the offers, Allah only accepts that which is granted with a clean intention.'

There up Qaabil, in anger and hatred, killed his brother.

In the Qur'ān no mention is made of the dispute over their marriage and neither are their names mentioned. Only

the story of their sacrificial offers is mentioned. Then it goes on to tell the story of the burial of Haabil's corpse.

After the killing, Qaabil was troubled as to what to do with the corpse of his brother. Up to that time the offspring of Nabi Adam ﷺ had never yet had to deal with death. For this reason Nabi Adam ﷺ did not as yet explain the Divine regulations regarding death of a human being.

Qaabil saw a crow using his claws to dig a hole in the ground and it immediately dawned upon him that in similar manner he should dig a hole in which to bury the corpse of his brother. According to another reports he saw the crow burying a dead crow in the hole and it dawned upon him to do similarly with his brother's corpse.

When Qaabil saw this he became intensely sorry over his life, saying to himself: "I am not even like this animal who hides his criminal act." In sorrow he bent his head and in similar manner buried the corpse of his brother. After telling this story the Qur'ān says:

"On account of that: We ordained for the children of Israel that if anyone slew a person—unless it be for murder or for spreading mischief in the land it would be as if he slew the whole people and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of the whole people." (5:32)

In his Musnad Imam Ahmad quoted a report by Ibn Mas'ud, where in Rasulullah ﷺ is reported to have said: "When in this world a murder takes place unjustly the sin will also be upon the neck of the eldest son of Nabi Adam ﷺ (Qaabil) because he is the first person to commit this unjust act and thereby initiated this unholy practice."

Warning

From these verses of *Surah Maidah* and the above-quoted *Hadith* we are warned that a man should under no circumstances be the first one to commence a certain sinful act, because whosoever in the world is going to commit that same act. The sin of performing that wrongful act is also going to the account of him who started it first. In this way he will become the recipient of everlasting humiliation and disgrace (May Allah save us from that).

Creation of the Universe

Before dealing with the facts contained in the Qur'ān concerning Hazrat Adam ﷺ, we have to cast our minds at the period before the arrival of man on this earth. In this regard science has opened up a new door of discussion viz. The theory of evolution. Those who believe in this theory maintain that man was not created and brought into existence as a human being all at once, but contend that before man appeared, he went through various stages of evolution until he came to his present form after millions of years. They contend that after life became created initially, it started in a primitive form and evolved through the plant Kingdom to the animal kingdom and after millions of years and numerous stages finally evolved to the stage where man appeared. That is the theory put forward by men of science.

Revelation on the other hand maintain that the creator of this Universe created the first man Hazrat Adam ﷺ in his complete form and then created his mate, Hazrat Hawwa and from the two of them the human race came into being. This is that man to whom Allah granted superiority over His other creatures and to whom he handed over the responsibility of carrying the *Amānat* of being His vicegerent on earth. To him He has made all the other creatures subservient: Allah says:

"Verily we have created man in the best mould."

(Al-Teen)

Further He says: "Indeed we have honoured the children of Adam."

(7:14)

He also declares:

"I shall place in this earth one who shall be my vicegerent."

He also states:

"We have offered the trust to the heavens and the earth and they all refused to take its responsibility and feared to take it, but man accepted to carry it."

(72:33)

What we have to see now is whether in reality there is a contradiction between the theory of evolution and what Revelation says, or if there is scope for reconciliation between the two views. It should be born in mind that our knowledge and experience have shown that there is no contradiction between religions truths and science. And if there does appear to exist such contradiction, it is merely because of some expects of science being hidden. And it has been seen very often that when the certain is lifted from those aspects, of science, the contradiction disappears by itself and the facts as proclaimed by Revelation become clear. In other words we may say that where those appears to be any contradiction between science and Revolution, science is left as it is and Revelation is given preference.

At this stage it is natural that the question should be asked: What is the truth of the matter? The truth is that on this point there is no real difference of opinion between science and Revelation. Both factions, whether they maintain

that man was created after a long period of evolution through various stages or whether they believe he was created all of a sudden in his original form, believe that man is the highest form of Allah's creation, having reached the highest rank in intellectual development and understanding, being answerable for his deeds and conduct and being liable under the law. In other words, in view of man's conduct and intellectual development and his stimulation towards morality, it does not matter how he originally came into being. What matters is the object for which he was created. Did he come into this world without any fixed objective or intention or did he come for a special purpose? Are the outcome of his words, deeds and conduct of no consequence? Are his material and spiritual powers of no sequence or are they valuable in the fruits they produce? Does his life hold with in it a brilliant reality for the future or does it point in the direction of a dark future and is his present and past completely unconnected with his future?

If the answers to these questions are not in the negative, then naturally we will have to admit that it is much more better to focus on the object of his existence so that we will have to accept that this, being, who is the best of creation, shows that there is a very great objective for his creation.

The Holy Qur'ān has dealt with both the positive and negative aspects of the object of man's creation and proclaimed the greatness of man's existence and further indicated that within the creation of Allah man has been created in "the best mould" and because of this best form he is worthy of honour and respect, thereby making him suitable to be granted the *Amanat* from Allah which made him the vice-gerent of Allah on earth.

Now in view of all this, how is it possible that he should be left alone to wander on earth without a fixed objective?

"Does man think that he will be left without any fixed objective?"
(75:36)

It is thus necessary that man's reason and intellect should be brought to such a level that it becomes superior to that of all the world in order for him to be able to distinguish clearly between good and evil to avoid evil and to be able to give preference to good.

" He created man and showed him the way (of good and evil)."
(20:50)

" We have shown man both ways (good and evil)."
(90:10)

Bear in mind further that the one who is addressed in the Qur'ān with all its exhortations, invitations, its orders towards good and its prohibition of evil, its calls towards guidance is this being called man. For this reason the Qur'ān left aside all details of man's creation and concentrated on his ending.

'Ask not the wise ones what is my beginning'

I am concerned about what is my ending' (Iqbal)

The Islāmic Outlook on Scientific Controversies

In cases of scientific controversies and discussions the Islāmic viewpoint is this that in those matters which had reached the level of certainty and experience, and where Qur'ānic knowledge and revelation does not deny or reject those findings, such findings should be accepted because the Qur'ān does not oppose clear observation and self evident truths. To reject such clear evident truths would be pure prejudice and narrow-mindedness.

As for those matters which had not yet reached the level that it can be said to be clear self-evident findings, like the question before us at the moment, one should not proceed to give interpretations to the Qur'ān to accomodate those views. In such cases one should not try to explain the verses in the light of these findings.

One should wait until such time that through time those theories become so accepted that to reject them would be tantamount to rejecting self-evident observations. It has been experienced that on many occasions scientific theories have been rejected and cast aside, whereas never once has it been that Qur'ānic truths have had to be rejected and cast aside. Whereas never once has it been that Qur'ānic truths have had to be rejected and set aside. On the other hand where a

scientific theory has had to be accepted as a fact, such acceptance did not mean that this fact had gone way ahead of what the Qur'ān actually stated.

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

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Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

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P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
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